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APPOINTMENTS

- Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, University of Texas at San Antonio, 2021–present
- Alvarez Research Fellow, Alvarez College of Business, University of Texas at San Antonio, 2025–present

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. Economics, Duke University, 2021
- M.S. Economics, Université Catholique de Louvain, Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium, 2013
- M.A. Economics, Universidad Nacional de Colombia, Bogotá, Colombia, 2013
- B.A. Economics, Universidad Nacional de Colombia, Bogotá, Colombia, 2011

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Urban economics, Housing Economics, Crime Economics, Media and Political Economy, Text-as-data and Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning

AFFILIATIONS

- Research Affiliate, CESifo — 2026–present

VISITING POSITIONS

- CESifo Visiting Researcher, Munich, Germany — Summer 2026

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] “Officer-Involved: The Media Language of Police Killings,” with Aurélie Ouss[✉]Patrick Bayer[✉]Bocar Ba. **Quarterly Journal of Economics**, 2025, 140 (2): 1525–1580. [[link](#)]
- [2] “Migrant exposure and anti-migrant sentiment: The case of the Venezuelan exodus,” with Jeremy Lebow, Salma Mousa, and Horacio Coral. **Journal of Public Economics**, 2024, 236: 105169. [[link](#)]
- [3] “Sinning in the Rain: Weather Shocks, Church Attendance and Crime.” **Review of Economics and Statistics**, 2023, 105 (1): 54–69. [[link](#)]

WORKING PAPERS

- [1] “The Pulpit and the Polls: The Electoral Impact of Religious Participation,” with Angela Cools and Sam Sheng. *Conditionally accepted*, **American Economic Review: Insights**. [[SocArXiv](#)]
- [2] “Crime News Bias: Extent and Effects on Housing Markets.” [[draft](#)]
- [3] “Items and Long-Run Outcomes: How to Measure Achievement and What Drives It,” with Eric Nielsen and Viviana Rodriguez. [[EdWorkingPapers](#)]
- [4] “A Framework for Interpreting High-Frequency Hedonic Price Dynamics with an Application to Valuing Homicide Risk,” with Patrick Bayer, Joe Fish and Marcus Casey.

GRANTS AND FUNDING

- (Co-PI) Urban Institute & Rockefeller Philanthropy Advisors, Student Upward Mobility Initiative. “Pinpointing When Economically Valuable Skill Gaps Emerge and Where Intervention Can Make a Difference.” \$103,400
- (Co-PI) Urban Institute & Rockefeller Philanthropy Advisors, Student Upward Mobility Initiative. “Test Items and Long-Run Outcomes.” \$153,200

- Seminar Series — Economics of Crime, Arnold Ventures. \$13,000 (2025–2026)

SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* *scheduled*; † *presented by co-author*

2027 AREUEA-ASSA 2027*

2026 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) International Conference (Medellín, Colombia); Duke University (Public/IO Seminar)*; Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime (Cornell)*; AI in Social Science Conference (University of Chicago)*; North American Urban Economic Association (NAUEA)*; NBER Summer Institute — Education†; Brown University (Reimagining Educational Measurement Workshop)†; University of Pennsylvania, Graduate School of Education†; CESifo — Public Economics Series (Munich, Germany)†; Annual Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP) (Chicago, IL)†; Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Culture (ASREC)†; European Journal of Political Economy (EJPE) Conference†; Liberal Arts College Public & Labor Conference†

2025 University of Wisconsin, Madison (Wisconsin School of Business); University of Oregon; Oregon State University; Western Economic Association (WEA); Southern Economic Association (SEA); CESifo — 19th Workshop on Political Economy; Politecnico di Milano School of Management†; Annual Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference (Seattle, WA)†

2024 Institute for Research on Poverty — University of Wisconsin, Madison (IRP); UT Austin; American Economics Association (ASSA); University of Houston; Southern Economic Association (SEA)

2023 NYC Media Seminar (CUNY and Columbia Business School); Text as Data in Policy Analysis Workshop (Stanford — Hoover); North American Econometric Society Meeting; North American Urban Economic Association (NAUEA); Southern Economic Association (SEA); Latin American Meeting of the Econometric Society (LAMES)*; International Economic Association (IEA) World Congress 2023

2022 American Real Estate and Urban Economic Association (AREUEA); European Urban Economic Association (EUEA); American Law and Economics Association (ALEA); Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)

2021 Southern Economic Association (SEA); North American Meeting of the Urban Economic Association (NAUEA); Davidson College; NBER Summer Institute — Real Estate; Triangle Applied Micro Conference (Duke); Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania; Rady School of Management, University of California, San Diego; University of Texas at San Antonio; Banco de la República, Colombia; Universidad de los Andes*

2020 Southern Economic Association (SEA); Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Culture (ASREC)

2018–19 Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Culture (ASREC); Catalan Economic Society

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Texas at San Antonio

- Causal Inference and Machine Learning (graduate): Spring 2026, 2025, 2024, 2023; Fall 2021
- Introduction to Econometrics (undergraduate): Spring 2024, 2023
- Introduction to Public Economics (undergraduate): Spring 2022; Fall 2021
- Economics of Public and Social Issues (undergraduate): Spring 2026; Fall 2024, 2023, 2022

Duke University

- R for Economics PhDs (graduate): Summer 2018
- Intermediate Microeconomics (undergraduate): Spring 2017

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: Quarterly Journal of Economics; American Economic Review; American Economic Review: Insights; Review of Economics and Statistics; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Human Resources; Journal of Human Capital; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Journal of Business and Economic Statistics; Economic Record; Scientific Reports; British Journal of Political Science; Journal of Law and Economics; Economics Letters

LANGUAGES

Human: Spanish (Native); English (Fluent); French (Conversational)

Programming (*pre-LLMs*): R; Stata; Python; SQL; MATLAB; Make